PROJECT REPORT:

Course Code: CSE0001

Scenario: Student Digital Ambassador

Details:

- Name: Aranyak Sarma
- Registration Number: 25BCE10994
- Branch: B.Tech CSE Core
- Year: First Year
- Course Code: CSE0001
- Date: March 29, 2026

INTRODUCTION:

This project serves as a comprehensive Digital Literacy Portfolio, developed through the lens of a Student Digital Ambassador. The primary objective is to demonstrate proficiency in navigating the digital world, from professional profile creation to safe online communication. Over five modules, this report documents the creation of educational infographics, the establishment of a professional technical presence, coding practice, and research into cybersecurity threats. The ultimate goal is to provide a roadmap for peers to use digital tools responsibly and effectively in an academic and professional capacity.

TASK 1:

For task 1, I used canva to make a comprehensive and sleek infographic on digital literacy awareness. I chose canva as it had various versatile design options and would allow me to splice in text along with symbols and image sprites making the infographic modern, sleek, vibrant yet informative and professional. With canva I could fit in important information without compromising the aesthetic nature of things. My design serves as a visual roadmap that highlights the five core pillars of digital literacy awareness being definitions, Useful Tools, Safe Internet Practices, Professional Online Presence, and Email Etiquette. The layout uses a structured, color-coded approach to ensure that critical information—such as the 1930 helpline for cybercrime and the importance of a GitHub README—is easily

scannable for a student audience. One thing I found particularly interesting while making this was the challenge of balancing text-based elements with the visual aspects like images. I had to balance the text-heavy advice, like email etiquette, with symbolic icons to ensure the poster didn't feel cluttered with text or look bland and boring. Compressing complex information and properly turning them into concise but comprehensive bullet points all the while balancing the design aspects made this a valuable learning experience.

TASK 2:

For Task 2, I established a comprehensive digital footprint by setting up professional profiles across five major platforms: GitHub, LinkedIn, Kaggle, Stack Overflow, and ResearchGate.

GitHub:

GitHub is used as a version control system and a hosting service for software development projects. One can create projects and upload it to GitHub by using specialised folders or repositories. I plan to host all my academic coding assignments and personal projects here to build a technical history of my growth as a developer over the course of my time in college.

LinkedIn

LinkedIn is a professional networking site used to connect with the academic community, industry experts, and internship coordinators. I plan to document my journey at VIT Bhopal by updating my skills and certifications every semester to build a strong profile for final year placements.

Kaggle

Kaggle is a platform for data science and machine learning competitions, providing access to public datasets. I will use Kaggle to participate in beginner-level data challenges during my second and third years, and slowly grow my level of skill and competence from that level, to build a specialized portfolio in Artificial Intelligence.

Stack Overflow

Stack Overflow is a collaborative Q&A platform for programmers to seek help and share technical knowledge. As I progress through my B.Tech CSE degree, I will shift from being a reader of answers to an active contributor, answering questions to improve my technical reputation within the developer community.

ResearchGate

ResearchGate is a professional network for scientists and researchers to share papers and collaborate on technical studies. In my final years, I will use this platform to follow researchers in my field of interest and eventually upload my own Capstone project or research papers.

TASK 3:

For task 3, I have focused on the two most important aspects of digital literacy in the modern world, technical problem solving and collaborating in data management. Using Python as the coding language, I took a coding challenge in HackerRank. This challenge required me to apply the knowledge I have in Data Structures and Algorithms (also called DSA) in solving a logic problem in a real-life

scenario, hence demonstrating my ability to write clean, efficient and functional code.

I also had to design a five-question quiz using Google Workspace on Digital Literacy Awareness. This required me to use the Google Forms application in assessing users' knowledge regarding various aspects of cybersecurity, including issues of phishing and the 1930 helpline. I can now analyse the various incoming responses from several of my batchmates. Thus, this quiz and response collection task demonstrated my ability to collaborate in data management, which is a very useful skill in academic and professional contexts.

TASK 4:

This task focused on the nuances of digital communication. I drafted two professional emails: one requesting a deadline extension from a professor and another expressing interest in a summer internship. Both drafts followed strict "Netiquette" rules, including clear subject lines and appropriate salutations.

I researched a scenario where a student used an unprofessional, demanding tone in an email to a faculty member, which led to a breakdown in communication and a denied request. This highlighted the importance of tone and structure. I learned that professional digital communication is about building respect and clarity; a poorly structured email can often be as damaging as a technical error in a project.

TASK 5:

For the final task, I conducted a case study on Phishing. I documented a realistic scenario where a student received a fraudulent email mimicking a university login page to steal VTOP credentials. Researching this topic surprised me because of how sophisticated modern social engineering tactics have become, often bypassing basic scepticism.

As a result, I have personally committed to never clicking a link in an email without first verifying the sender's official domain. I also developed a 'Stay Safe Online' checklist that includes specific tips for UPI safety and provides the National Cyber Crime Helpline (1930) for reporting incidents. Digital safety is a continuous habit, not a one-time setup.

CONCLUSION:

This project has significantly enhanced my understanding of what it means to be digitally literate in a professional and academic environment. Beyond just using tools, I have learned the importance of maintaining a professional brand, communicating with integrity, and staying vigilant against online threats. As I move forward in my CSE Core career, these foundational digital skills will be as important as the code I write.

REFERENCES:

- Canva: canva.com
- GitHub: github.com
- HackerRank: hackerrank.com
- National Cyber Crime Portal: https://www.cybercrime.gov.in
- LinkedIn: linkedin.com